

PROSPER AWUNI

Security Engineer | Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) / Extended Detection and Response (XDR) | Microsoft Sentinel and Detection-as-Code

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of hands-on experience as a Security Engineer specialising in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Extended Detection and Response (XDR), detection-as-code, and Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR). I have deep practical expertise in Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), building and maintaining detection content, automating response workflows, and reducing attacker dwell time across complex enterprise environments. I am equally comfortable developing Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rules, maintaining SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, and driving detection engineering improvements aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework. I am UK-based and comfortable travelling to sites at short notice when the role requires it.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL, analytics rules, workbooks, data connectors), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, detection-as-code, alert tuning, detection lifecycle management
- **XDR and Endpoint Security:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Microsoft Defender for Identity, Microsoft 365 Defender (XDR), CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Prevent, Insight and Discover
- **SOAR and Security Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel playbooks (Logic Apps), SOAR orchestration, PowerShell scripting, automated enrichment and response workflows
- **Detection-as-Code:** KQL-based analytics rule development, MITRE ATT&CK coverage mapping, use-case lifecycle management, detection gap analysis
- **Cloud and Identity Security:** Microsoft Azure, Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentra breach and attack simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Threat Intelligence and Hunting:** Intelligence-led threat hunting, attacker tactics, techniques and procedures (TTP) analysis, MITRE ATT&CK mapping, CrowdStrike Falcon Insight
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle, triage, containment, eradication and post-incident review
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL)

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

- Own the SIEM and XDR detection engineering function, developing and maintaining KQL analytics rules in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, mapping all content to MITRE ATT&CK and maintaining a detection-as-code discipline with version control and peer review.
- Build, test, and maintain SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel (Logic Apps) to automate alert enrichment, tier-one response actions, and cross-tool orchestration, measurably reducing analyst workload and mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Administer and extend Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, and Microsoft 365 Defender XDR, correlating signals across endpoint, identity, and email to improve detection coverage and accelerate incident triage.
- Lead Tier 3 incident response, owning end-to-end case management from detection through containment, eradication, and post-incident review aligned to NIST 800-61.

- Govern identity security within Microsoft Entra ID, designing and enforcing Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement, and privileged access controls through BeyondTrust PAM.
- Drive vulnerability management using Pentera BAS, Tenable.io, and AppCheck across an 8,000-user estate, collaborating with infrastructure teams to prioritise and track remediation.
- Maintain and tune data connectors, workbooks, and dashboards within Microsoft Sentinel to ensure visibility across cloud, endpoint, identity, and network telemetry.

University of the Arts London (UAL)

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Deployed and operationalised CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across an 8,000-user estate, developing detection policies, exclusions, and response workflows that balanced security efficacy with operational stability.
- Authored KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel to identify credential-based attacks, data exfiltration, anomalous administrative activity, and lateral movement, continuously refining logic based on threat intelligence and hunt findings.
- Built SOAR automation in PowerShell and Microsoft Sentinel playbooks to accelerate alert enrichment and enforce consistent response actions at scale.
- Conducted regular threat hunting investigations using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel, applying intelligence-led hypotheses and MITRE ATT&CK TTPs to surface threats below the detection threshold.
- Managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Defender for Identity configurations, policies, and response actions to maintain XDR coverage across the user estate.
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access and MFA, reducing credential-based attack surface and supporting Zero Trust adoption.
- Produced security reporting and metrics dashboards using Sentinel workbooks and CrowdStrike Falcon Discover to demonstrate programme effectiveness to senior stakeholders.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech)

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Managed security operations within a cloud-first SaaS environment, maintaining SIEM alerting, endpoint protection, identity access controls, and patch compliance.
- Configured Check Point Harmony firewall policies, Mimecast email security, and Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM).
- Triage and responded to security incidents, coordinating containment and remediation across infrastructure and development teams.
- Supported ISO 27001 compliance activities, documentation, and internal audit processes.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Established a detection-as-code practice for SIEM rule development in Microsoft Sentinel, introducing version control, peer review, and MITRE ATT&CK tagging across the full detection library.
- Deployed and operationalised CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across an 8,000-user university estate, delivering end-to-end detection engineering and threat hunting capability.
- Built a SOAR playbook library automating alert enrichment and tier-one response for the highest-volume alert types, reducing mean time to respond across the SOC.
- Developed a suite of custom KQL analytics rules in Microsoft Sentinel targeting identity-based attacks, data exfiltration, and anomalous administrative behaviour, closing significant detection gaps.
- Led complex cross-functional incident response exercises that improved organisational readiness and reduced repeat incident rates through structured post-incident reviews.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+

- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Remote (London/UK)